

THE GARAMUT



A MESSAGE SENDER

Ps Barry's Reflections on: **PRAYER, PROCLAMATION and PERSONAL PROGRESS**

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I AM WHAT I AM

A CONTENTMENT WITH WHO I AM
FEELING HAPPY WITH WHO I AM

Recently this short statement *I am what I am* impacted me with such positive thoughts of thankfulness and appreciation as it aptly described the state of wellbeing and contentment that I felt was mine in Christ.

I experienced a new sense of happiness and contentment with WHO I AM – simply because of God's grace bestowed upon me.

I felt happy with who I am

1 Corinthians 15:10 But by the grace of God *I am what I am*; and his grace which was bestowed upon me was not in vain; but I laboured more abundantly than they all: yet not I, but the grace of God which was with me. KJV

1 Corinthians 15:10 But by the grace of God *I am what I am*, and his grace to me was not without effect. No, I worked harder than all of them — yet not I, but the grace of God that was with me. NIV

A commentary of 1 Corinthians 15:10

"I am what I am" is a statement of self-acceptance and authenticity, meaning a person embraces their true self, strengths and weaknesses, without apology or reservation. It suggests confidence and a lack of need to conform to external expectations.

EVERY BELIEVER

The apostle's statement should be read and viewed in a way that gives to us a sense of wellbeing, contentment and acceptance of oneself in a positive light not a negative one.

It should no longer be viewed as one of lament and disappointment at the hopeless and sorrowful state of our condition before God, where we see ourselves hopelessly imprisoned in this saddened state of where there is no release.

BUT that is not true anymore because **GRACE CAME IN AND CHANGED THINGS.**

GRACE MADE THE DIFFERENCE

Now my perspective of *who I am* is a living reality, resulting in a sense of contentment and happiness with myself.

Understanding God's grace IN ALL its truth. (Colossians 1:6)

I am also confident that what the grace of God has worked in my life will continue to work and affect the necessary changes needed.

The apostle writing to the believers in city of Colossi states: "... **All over the world this gospel is bearing fruit and growing, just as it has been doing among you since the day you heard it and understood God's grace in all its truth.** Colossians 1:6 NIV

Now I accept myself, as to who I am – which means my identity, character, temperament, weaknesses, strengths and my total vulnerability. Also without being pressured to conform to any expectations.

I am PLEASED with what GRACE has produced in me.

ANOTHER TIME IN MY LIFE

HOWEVER, there was a time in my life when I was very unhappy with myself and how I viewed myself. I longed to be different to who I was.

I asked the question a thousand times; "*why was I made like this, why am I so different to others? Why am I like this?*"

And I was constantly haunted with these kinds of thoughts – even though I covered it from others with a macho-kind of bravado.

This was a never-ending cycle and **there was no peace, no sense of happiness of lasting contentment** only the constant sense of aloneness and hopelessness.

And even as a believer I continued to see myself as before and so I always read this statement **"I am what I am"** in a negative and self-condemning way.

BUT THEN ONE DAY I saw for the first time what actually took place **when God showered his grace on me. When grace entered my life.**

This was like Psalm 85:10 declares; **GRACE** and **MERCY** met and kissed each other.

*Psalms 85:10 **Grace and truth have met together**; justice and peace have kissed each other. CJB*

*Psalms 85:10 **Mercy and loving-kindness and truth have met together**; righteousness and peace have kissed each other. AMP*

GOD'S GRACE WAS THE IMPORTANT FACTOR IN ENABLING ME TO CONFIDENTLY SAY: **"I AM WHAT I AM"**

IT WAS GRACE THAT MADE THE DIFFERENCE IN ME UNDERSTANDING AND APPRECIATING WHO I WAS.

I began to appreciate and understand **what grace had made me.**

BUT

1. I first had to **SEE** what grace had done,
2. Then I had to **ACCEPT** that it was TRUE for me,
3. Followed by **SPEAKING, SAYING, DECLARING** it too be TRUE for MY LIFE.

These three steps caused me to **SEE** MYSELF DIFFERENTLY and NOT like the old negative self-condemning person I thought I was.

The entrance of Grace into my life CHANGED my opinion of myself.

And that **grace** was not without effect or result because it produced in me **a new viewpoint** of myself and not only to me but to every believer in Christ.

We must see what **the work of grace** has done for us.

Saved by Grace - Ephesians 2:8 - Ephesians 2:5

Justified by Grace Romans 3:24

Favoured through Grace Ephesians 1:6

Redemption & Forgiveness through Grace Ephesians 1:7

Access Into His Grace Romans 5:2

Righteousness reigning through Grace. Romans 5: 21

Grace and Peace from God the Father. Galatians 1:3

AND THIS IS ALSO TRUE FOR EVERY BELIEVER

*John 1:17 For the law was given through Moses; **grace and truth came through Jesus Christ.** NIV*

GRACE APPEARED AND ENTERED INTO OUR LIVES through the redemptive work of Christ on the Cross.

This truth has been there all the time I did not 'see' it.

Often divine truth is not seen and so the believer cannot avail themselves of the benefits it contains and so they continue to believe something different.

IMPORTANT QUESTIONS WE MUST ASK OURSELVES

- **ARE YOU HAPPY WITH WHO YOU ARE?**
- **WHAT DO YOU REALLY THINK ABOUT OURSELVES?**
- **ARE YOU CONTENT WITH WHO YOU ARE?**
- **WHAT IS YOUR RESPONSE TO THE APOSTLE'S STATEMENT – "I AM WHAT I AM"**
- **DO YOU UNDERSTAND WHAT GRACE HAS ACTUALLY PRODUCED IN YOU?**
- **IF SO, ARE YOU SATISFIED IN THAT KNOWLEDGE THAT YOU ARE WHAT GRACE HAS MADE YOU?**
- **IF NOT THEN MAYBE YOU SHOULD REFLECT AGAIN ON WHAT THE WORK OF GRACE HAD DONE FOR US AT SALVATION.**

THE WORK OF GRACE

The work of Grace in us has to mean something in relation to what the apostle confidently states **"I AM WHAT I AM by the grace of God"**

- Grace had to **produce** something in us it had to positively **affect** our lives in some way; and it did.
- Grace effectively dealt with our:
 - Insecurities, low self-esteem, negative opinion of ourselves.
 - It also re-establishes our identity, dignity and worth.
- **God's grace** dramatically changed our status before God and enabled US to have a **POSITIVE PERSPECTIVE** of ourselves.

Amen Ps Barry